assessments may be made. These could be made within the head office technical departments. In other cases, classification societies or independent organizations may need to be contacted. The Plan should clearly indicate who the master should contact in order to gain access to these facilities
. 2 Where appropriate, the Plan should provide a list of information required for making damage stability and damaged longitudinal strength assessments.
2.5.3.3 Lightening: Should the ship sustain extensive structural damage, it may be necessary to transfer all or part of the cargo to another ship. The Plan should provide guidance on procedures to be followed for ship-to-ship transfer of cargo. Reference may be made in the Plan to existing company guides. A copy of such company procedures for ship-to-ship transfer operations should be kept with the Plan. The Plan should address the need for co-ordinating this activity with the coastal State, as such operation may be subject to its jurisdiction.
2.5.4 In order to have the necessary information available to respond to the situations referred to in paragraph 2.5.2, certain plans, drawings, and

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
subject to its jurisdiction.
2.5.4 In order to have the necessary information available to respond to the situations referred to in paragraph 2.5.2, certain plans, drawings, and ship-specific details such as, a layout of a general arrangement plan, a tank plan, etc., should be appended. The Plan should show where current cargo, bunker and ballast information, including quantities and specifications, are available.
W/ 6725D/EWP
RESOLUTION MEPC.54(32)
adopted on 6 March 1992
GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD
OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLANSMEPC 32/20
ANNEX 4
Page 12
2.6 National and local co-ordination: Quick, efficient co-ordination between the ship and coastal State or other involved parties becomes vital in mitigating the effects of a pollution incident. The Plan should address the need to contact the coastal State for authorization prior to undertaking mitigating actions.
2.6.1 The identities and roles of various national and local authorities involved vary widely from State to State and even from port to port. Approaches to responsibility for discharge response also vary. Some coastal

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mitigating actions.
2.6.1 The identities and roles of various national and local authorities involved vary widely from State to State and even from port to port. Approaches to responsibility for discharge response also vary. Some coastal States have agencies that take charge of response immediately and subsequently bill the owner for the cost. In other coastal States, responsibility for

initiating response is placed on the shipowner. In the case of the latter the Plan will require greater detail and guidance to assist the master with organizing this response.
3 NON-MANDATORY PROVISIONS
3.1 In addition to the provisions required by regulation 26 of Annex I of the Convention, local requirements, insurance company, or owner/operator policies, etc., may dictate that other guidance be provided in the Plan. These topics may include: provision of diagrams and drawings; ship carried response equipment; public affairs; record-keeping; and reference materials.
3.2 Plans and diagrams: In addition to the plans required by section 2.5.4 above, other details concerning the ship's design and construction may be appended to the Plan or their location identified.

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
3.2 Plans and diagrams: In addition to the plans required by section 2.5.4 above, other details concerning the ship's design and construction may be appended to the Plan or their location identified.
3.3 Response equipment: Some ships may carryon board equipment to assist in pollution response. The type and quantity of this equipment may vary widely. The Plan should indicate an inventory of such equipment, if carried. It should also provide directions for safe use and guidelines to assist the master in determining when such use is warranted. Care should be exercised to ensure that the use of such equipment by the crew is practical and consistent with safety considerations. When such equipment is carried, the Plan should establish personnel responsibilities for its deployment, oversight, and maintenance. In order to ensure safe and effective use of such equipment, the Plan should also provide for crew training in the use of it. The Plan should include a provision that no chemical agent should be used for response to pollution on the sea without authorization of the appropriate coastal State and that such authorization should also be requested, when required, for use

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should include a provision that no chemical agent should be used for response to pollution on the sea without authorization of the appropriate coastal State and that such authorization should also be requested, when required, for use of containment or recovery equipment.
3.4 Public affairs: The owners may want to include in the Plan guidance for the master in dealing with the distribution of information to the news media. Such guidance should be fashioned to reduce the burden on ship's personnel already busy with the emergency at hand.
3.5 Record-keeping: As with any other incident that will eventually involve liability, compensation and reimbur~ement issues, the bwner may want to include in his Plan guidance for the keeping of appropriate records of the pollution incident. Apart from detailing all actions taken on board, records might include communications with outside authorities, owners, and other parties, as well as a brief summary of decisions and information passed and received. Guidance on collecting of samples of spilled oil as well as that carried on board may also be provided.
W/6725D/EWP

adopted on 6 March 1992

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received. Guidance on collecting of samples of spilled oil as well as that carried on board may also be provided.
W/6725D/EWP
RESOLUTION MEPC.54(32)
adopted on 6 March 1992
GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD
OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLANSMEPC 32/20
ANNEX 4
Page 13
3.6 Plan review: Regular review of the Plan by the owner, operator or master is recommended to ensure that the specific information contained therein is current. A feedback system should be employed which will allow quick capture of changing information and incorporation of it into the Plan. This feedback system should incorporate the following two means:
.1 periodic review: the Plan should be reviewed by the owner or operator at least yearly to capture changes in local law or policy, contact names and numbers, ship characteristics, or company policy;
.2 event review: after any use of the Plan in response to an incident, its effectiveness should be evaluated by the owner or operator and modifications made accordingly.
3.7 Plan testing: The Plan will be of little value if it is not made familiar to the personnel who will use it. Regular exercises will ensure that the Plan

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SOURCE: MEPC.54(32).pdf
modifications made accordingly.
3.7 Plan testing: The Plan will be of little value if it is not made familiar to the personnel who will use it. Regular exercises will ensure that the Plan functions as expected and that the contacts and communications specified are accurate. Such exercises may be held in conjunction with other shipboard exercises and appropriately logged. Where Ships carry response equipment, hands on experience with it by crew members will greatly enhance safety and effectiveness in an emergency situation. Procedures for training and exercise may be defined.
W/6725D/EWP
RESOLUTION MEPC.54(32)
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GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD
OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLANSMEPC 32/20
ANNEX 4
Page 14
APPENDIX I
The following publications are suggested to provide additional assistance in the preparation of Plans:
Manual on Oil Pollution, Section II, Contingency Planning
International Maritime Organization (IMO)
ISBN 92 801 1233 3
Available in English, French, and Spanish from IMO, publications Section,

4 Albert Embankment, London SEI 7SR
Response to Marine Oil Spills
International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation (ITOPF)

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ISBN 92 801 1233 3
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4 Albert Embankment, London SEI 7SR
Response to Marine Oil Spills
International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation (ITOPF)
ISBN 0 948691 51 4
Available in English, French, and Spanish from Witherby & Co. Ltd.,
32-36 Aylesbury Street, London ECIR OET
Provisions Concerning the Reporting of Incidents Involving Harmful Substances
under MARPOL 73/78
IMO
ISBN 92 801 1261 9
Available in English, French and Spanish from IMO Publications Section
International Safety Guide for Oil Tankers and Terminals
ISBN 0 948691 62 X
Available from Witherby & Co. Ltd., London